



APPALACHIAN VALLEY MEDICAL CENTER

Acceptable Use Policy

AVMC Information Technology & Security

Policy Owner	AVMC Information Technology and Security
Applies To	Workforce members, contractors, students, vendors, volunteers, and other authorized users
Review Cycle	At least annually and after significant technology, operational, legal, or cybersecurity-risk changes

1. Purpose

Appalachian Valley Medical Center's (AVMC) Acceptable Use Policy establishes requirements for the safe, responsible, and authorized use of AVMC systems, networks, devices, applications, and data.

AVMC relies on technology for patient care, clinical operations, imaging and laboratory services, pharmacy operations, administration, building management, physical security, and other hospital functions. Misuse of these resources can expose AVMC to cybersecurity incidents, unauthorized disclosure of sensitive information, service disruptions, malware, ransomware, and other operational risks.

All users must use AVMC technology to support organizational operations while protecting the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of AVMC systems and information.

2. Scope

This policy applies to anyone who accesses technology resources owned or managed by AVMC. These resources include workstations, laptops, servers, network equipment, clinical systems, medical and IoT devices, wireless networks, applications, email, internet access, removable media, building-management and physical-security systems, and any other devices connected to AVMC networks.

This policy applies whether access is made from an AVMC-owned device, an authorized personal device, or an approved remote location. Devices used by guests and patients on AVMC's guest wireless network must comply with AVMC network restrictions and may not access internal AVMC systems.

3. Acceptable Use Requirements

AVMC technology resources shall be used primarily for authorized healthcare, administrative, operational, educational, and other legitimate organizational purposes. Users may access only the systems, applications, network segments, files, and information required for their assigned duties. Technical access to a resource does not constitute authorization to use it.

Users must safeguard their credentials and may not share passwords or accounts. They are responsible for all activity conducted through their assigned accounts. When appropriate, users shall lock or sign out of unattended AVMC workstations and devices and take reasonable steps to prevent unauthorized access to or viewing of AVMC information. Sensitive organizational, patient, employee, and operational information shall be handled only through authorized AVMC systems and services.

4. Prohibited Activities

- Attempt to circumvent AVMC security controls, including access-control lists, network segmentation, authentication requirements, and monitoring systems.
- Access patient, clinical, administrative, security, or operational information without an authorized business or clinical purpose.
- Install unauthorized software, applications, network equipment, wireless access points, or devices on AVMC systems or networks.
- Disable or disrupt endpoint protection, logging, authentication, security monitoring, or other AVMC security controls.
- Introduce malicious software or intentionally engage in activities that could disrupt AVMC systems or services.
- Perform unauthorized scanning, exploitation, password attacks, interception, or other security testing.
- Connect unauthorized removable media or external storage to AVMC systems.
- Share confidential AVMC information through unauthorized personal email, cloud storage, messaging, social media, or file-sharing services.
- Use another person's account or allow anyone else to use assigned credentials.
- Use AVMC technology for illegal, abusive, fraudulent, or materially disruptive purposes.

Limited incidental personal use may be allowed if it does not interfere with work duties, consume excessive resources, violate AVMC policy, create cybersecurity risks, or involve sensitive AVMC information.

5. Email, Internet, and Phishing Safety

Users must exercise caution when opening email attachments, clicking links, downloading files, or responding to unexpected requests for information. They must promptly report suspicious messages, unexpected authentication requests, unusual system behavior, suspected malware, and potential phishing attempts through AVMC's incident-reporting process.

Users must not knowingly open or run suspicious attachments or bypass browser, email, or endpoint-security warnings without authorization from AVMC IT/Security. A compromised account or endpoint can give an attacker an initial foothold to spread ransomware or other malicious activity.

6. Network and Wireless Use

Users shall connect AVMC devices only to network resources authorized for their roles and device types. AVMC maintains logically separated network zones for distinct operational purposes, including clinical systems, medical IoT, servers, IT management, guest access, and Facilities/BMS systems. Users shall not attempt to bypass these boundaries.

Guest and personal devices shall use the designated guest network when applicable and may access protected AVMC internal resources only with specific authorization. Medical IoT and Facilities/BMS devices shall communicate only with the systems and services necessary for their intended functions.

7. Protection of Sensitive Information

AVMC information shall be accessed, stored, transmitted, or disclosed only as required for authorized duties. Users must take reasonable steps to prevent unauthorized individuals from viewing sensitive information on screens, printed documents, or other media.

Sensitive AVMC information shall not be copied to personal devices, personal cloud-storage accounts, unauthorized removable media, or other unapproved locations. Any suspected loss, exposure, alteration, or unauthorized disclosure of AVMC information must be reported immediately.

8. Security Monitoring and Privacy Expectations

AVMC may monitor, log, and review activity on its systems and networks for cybersecurity, operations, compliance, troubleshooting, and incident response. Users should not expect activity on AVMC-owned or

managed technology to be private from authorized monitoring. Security logs and monitoring data must be protected from unauthorized access or alteration.

9. Security Incident Reporting

Users must promptly report suspected cybersecurity incidents to AVMC IT/Security, including suspicious emails, ransomware messages, unexpected file changes, lost or stolen devices, unauthorized access, malware alerts, unusual system behavior, exposed credentials, and suspected disclosures of sensitive information.

Unless directed by authorized incident-response personnel, users shall not independently investigate, delete evidence, negotiate with attackers, or attempt remediation outside established AVMC procedures.

10. Responsibilities

- All users: follow this policy, safeguard credentials and devices, and promptly report suspected security incidents.
- Managers and department leaders: ensure personnel understand acceptable-use requirements and have access appropriate to their duties.
- AVMC IT/Security personnel: implement and maintain safeguards, monitor systems, investigate suspected violations, and support incident response.
- AVMC leadership: approve cybersecurity policy, support enforcement, and provide resources to manage cybersecurity risk.

Policy violations may result in restricted or revoked access and, when appropriate, additional administrative, contractual, or legal action.

11. NIST Cybersecurity Framework 2.0 Mapping

This policy primarily maps to the GOVERN and PROTECT Functions of the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0.

CSF 2.0 Area	AVMC Policy Alignment	Application
GV.PO - Policy	Establishes and communicates acceptable-use requirements and requires periodic review.	Sections 1-11
GV.RR - Roles, Responsibilities, and Authorities	Assigns responsibilities to users, managers, IT/Security, and leadership.	Section 10
PR.AA - Identity Management, Authentication, and Access Control	Requires credential protection and limits access to authorized systems and resources.	Sections 3, 4, 6
PROTECT (PR)	Supports safeguards for access, user behavior, devices, networks, and sensitive information.	Sections 3-8

References

National Institute of Standards and Technology. (2024). The NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0. NIST CSWP 29. <https://doi.org/10.6028/NIST.CSWP.29>

SANS Institute. Security Policy Templates. <https://www.sans.org/information-security-policy>